

Greenfield University Library Rules and Regulations

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1. Introduction and Purpose

The Greenfield University Central Library (“the Library”) serves as the primary knowledge resource center for the university community. This document establishes the rules, procedures, and expectations governing the use of library facilities, materials, and services across all Greenfield University campuses, including the Main Campus (Greenfield City) and the North Campus (Hillview).

The Library’s mission is to support teaching, learning, and research by providing equitable, well-organized, and timely access to print and digital resources. These rules apply uniformly to the Central Library, the Departmental Libraries (Engineering, Law, Medicine, and Management), and the 24-Hour Reading Annex.

All members are expected to read and comply with this document. Ignorance of library rules is not accepted as a valid reason for waiving fines or disciplinary consequences.

2. Library Membership

2.1 Eligibility

Category	Eligibility	Membership Validity
Undergraduate Students	Enrolled in any UG program	Duration of program + 30 days
Postgraduate Students	Enrolled in any PG program	Duration of program + 30 days
Research Scholars (M.Phil./Ph.D.)	Registered scholars	Duration of registration + 90 days
Faculty (Full-time)	Active employment contract	Duration of employment

Faculty (Visiting/Adjunct)	Approved by HOD and Librarian	Per semester, renewable
Administrative Staff	Active employment contract	Duration of employment
Alumni	Graduated within last 5 years	1 year, renewable annually
External/Guest Members	Approved by Chief Librarian	6 months, non-renewable beyond 2 cycles

2.2 Registration Process

1. New students and staff must register at the Circulation Desk within the first **two weeks** of admission or joining.
2. A valid Greenfield University ID card is mandatory for registration.
3. Members must submit one passport-size photograph and complete the Library Membership Form (available at the Circulation Desk or via the Student Portal under “Library Services”).
4. A refundable security deposit applies as follows:

Member Category	Security Deposit (INR)
Undergraduate Students	1,000
Postgraduate Students	1,500
Research Scholars	2,000
Faculty	Nil
External Members	3,000

5. The library card is non-transferable. Sharing your library card with another individual is a violation of this policy and may result in suspension of borrowing privileges for both parties.

2.3 Loss of Library Card

A lost library card must be reported immediately to the Circulation Desk to prevent unauthorized use. A duplicate card will be issued upon payment of a **INR 200 replacement fee** and submission of a written request.

3. Library Timings

3.1 Regular Semester Hours

Facility	Monday-Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Central Library (General Access)	8:00 AM - 10:00 PM	9:00 AM - 6:00 PM	10:00 AM - 4:00 PM
Circulation Desk (Issue/Return)	8:30 AM - 8:30 PM	9:30 AM - 5:00 PM	Closed
24-Hour Reading Annex	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours
Departmental Libraries	9:00 AM - 6:00 PM	9:00 AM - 1:00 PM	Closed
Digital Resource Center	8:00 AM - 9:00 PM	9:00 AM - 5:00 PM	Closed

3.2 Examination Period Hours (Extended)

During officially notified examination periods (mid-semester and end-semester), the Central Library and Reading Annex extend hours as follows:

- Central Library: **7:00 AM - 12:00 Midnight**
- Reading Annex: Remains open 24 hours with enhanced security staffing
- Circulation Desk: **8:00 AM - 10:00 PM**

3.3 Vacation and Holiday Hours

During semester breaks, summer vacation, and winter recess, the Library operates on reduced hours:

- Central Library: **10:00 AM - 5:00 PM**, Monday to Friday only
- Reading Annex: **8:00 AM - 8:00 PM** (not 24-hour during vacation periods)

- Departmental Libraries: Closed (materials accessible via Central Library only)

The Library remains **closed on all national holidays** and on University-declared closure days. A list of holiday closures is published on the Library notice board and the University website each January.

4. Borrowing Rules and Circulation Policy

4.1 Borrowing Limits

Member Category	Books	Journals/Periodicals	Reference Books	Loan Period
Undergraduate Students	4	2 (reading room only)	Not issuable	14 days
Postgraduate Students	6	3 (reading room only)	Not issuable	21 days
Research Scholars	10	5	1 (overnight, with approval)	30 days
Faculty	15	8	3	Full Semester
Administrative Staff	3	1	Not issuable	14 days
Alumni	2	Not issuable	Not issuable	14 days
External Members	2	Not issuable	Not issuable	7 days

4.2 General Borrowing Conditions

- Books must be checked out at the Circulation Desk or via the self-checkout kiosks located on the Ground Floor and 2nd Floor.
- Members are responsible for inspecting books at the time of issue. Any pre-existing damage (torn pages, markings, missing pages) must be reported to library staff **before** leaving the desk; otherwise, the borrower will be held liable for the damage upon return.
- Textbooks under high demand (course reserves) may carry a shorter loan period of **3 days** and cannot be renewed during peak demand periods, as determined by the Librarian.
- A member with outstanding fines exceeding **INR 500** will have borrowing privileges suspended until the dues are cleared.
- A member with more than **two overdue items** cannot borrow additional materials until the overdue items are returned or renewed.

4.3 Restricted Materials

The following categories **cannot be borrowed** under any circumstances and must be used within the library premises:

- Reference books, encyclopedias, and dictionaries (general collection)
- Rare books and special collections (Archives Room)
- Theses and dissertations
- Current issue of journals and magazines (back issues older than 6 months may be borrowed by faculty and research scholars only)
- Maps, atlases, and bound newspaper volumes

5. Reservation and Renewal Procedures

5.1 Reservations

- If a desired book is currently issued to another member, students may place a reservation through the Library Portal or at the Circulation Desk.
- The reserving member will be notified via university email or SMS within **24 hours** of the book's return.
- Reserved books are held at the Circulation Desk for **48 hours** from the notification. If not collected within this window, the reservation is canceled and the book returns to general circulation.
- A maximum of **3 active reservations** is permitted per member at any given time.

5.2 Renewals

- Books may be renewed up to **2 times**, provided no other member has placed a reservation on the same title.
- Renewals can be done online via the Library Portal, by phone, or in person at the Circulation Desk.
- Renewal requests must be made **before** the due date. Renewals are not permitted for items that are already overdue; overdue fines must first be cleared.
- Course reserve materials and high-demand textbooks are generally **not eligible** for renewal.

5.3 Recall Policy

The Library reserves the right to recall any borrowed item before the due date if it is urgently required for course reserves, faculty research, or institutional accreditation review. Members will be given a minimum of **5 working days'** notice for recalled items.

6. Fines, Penalties, and Lost Book Policy

6.1 Overdue Fines

Member Category	Fine Per Day (INR)	Maximum Fine Per Item (INR)
Undergraduate Students	5	200
Postgraduate Students	5	250
Research Scholars	10	400
Faculty	10	500
Administrative Staff	5	200
Alumni / External Members	10	300

Fines accrue automatically and are calculated from the day immediately following the due date, including Sundays and holidays when the library is closed.

6.2 Payment of Fines

- Fines can be paid online through the Student Portal (Library → My Account → Pending Dues), at the Accounts Section, or at the Circulation Desk via cash or card.
- Fines must be cleared before semester-end clearance, re-registration, or issuance of the Transfer/Migration Certificate.
- Unpaid fines exceeding **INR 1,000** will be reported to the Dean of Student Affairs and may result in withholding of examination hall tickets.

6.3 Lost or Damaged Books

Scenario	Action Required
Book lost	Replace with the same edition, or pay the current market price plus a processing fee of INR 100
Book damaged (minor - e.g., highlighting, dog-eared pages)	Warning recorded; fine of INR 50-150 depending on severity
Book damaged (major - e.g., torn/missing pages, water damage)	Full replacement cost plus INR 200 processing fee
Book not returned after 90 days overdue	Automatically classified as "Lost"; replacement procedure applies, and the matter is referred to the Discipline Committee

If the exact edition of a lost book is unavailable in the market, the Librarian will determine a fair replacement value based on the current edition's price, subject to a minimum of **INR 500**.

6.4 Fine Waivers

Fine waivers may be granted only under the following documented circumstances, subject to approval by the Chief Librarian:

- Medical emergency (hospitalization), supported by a medical certificate

- Approved University-sponsored travel or academic deputation
- System/technical error attributable to the Library (e.g., incorrect due date recorded)

Waiver requests must be submitted in writing within **15 days** of the fine being levied, using the Fine Waiver Request Form available at the Circulation Desk.

7. Reading Room and Study Space Rules

7.1 General Conduct

- Maintain silence in all designated Silent Study Zones (2nd and 3rd floors). Discussion and group study are permitted only in the Collaborative Learning Zone (Ground Floor, East Wing).
- Mobile phones must be switched to silent mode. Phone calls must be taken outside the reading areas.
- Eating is not permitted inside reading rooms. Covered water bottles are allowed; other beverages and snacks must be consumed only in the designated Library Café area.
- Personal belongings (bags, laptops, books) should not be left unattended to reserve seats for more than **20 minutes**. Library staff may relocate unattended items, and the Library is not responsible for loss of personal belongings.

7.2 Seating Reservation for Exams

During examination periods, students may reserve a fixed seat for the semester by registering at the Help Desk, subject to availability. Seat reservations are non-transferable and will be forfeited if the seat remains unused for **3 consecutive days** without prior notice.

7.3 Group Study Rooms

- Six Group Study Rooms (capacity 4–8 persons) are available on the Ground Floor on a first-come, first-served basis, bookable up to 48 hours in advance via the Library Portal.
 - Maximum booking duration is **3 hours per group per day**.
 - Rooms must be vacated on time and left clean; repeated violations result in suspension of booking privileges for 30 days.
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8. Digital Library and E-Resources

8.1 Access

All registered members have access to the Greenfield University Digital Library, which includes:

- E-journals (JSTOR, IEEE Xplore, ScienceDirect, SpringerLink)
- E-books (over 45,000 titles across disciplines)
- Institutional Repository (theses, dissertations, faculty publications)
- Past examination question papers (last 10 years)
- Online databases for plagiarism checking (Turnitin) — available to faculty and research scholars for academic verification purposes

8.2 Remote Access

- Students and faculty can access e-resources off-campus using their university credentials through the VPN portal at remote.greenfield.edu.
- Remote access credentials are deactivated automatically upon graduation or end of employment, except for the 30-day/90-day grace periods specified in Section 2.1.

8.3 Usage Policy for E-Resources

- Bulk downloading, systematic scraping, or redistribution of e-resources is strictly prohibited and may result in the University's access to that database being suspended by the publisher, affecting the entire student body.
- Each member is limited to a reasonable personal-use download volume; the Digital Resource Center monitors

usage patterns and will issue a warning for unusual download activity before escalating to account suspension.

- Sharing personal login credentials for e-resource access with non-members is a violation of publisher licensing agreements and University policy.

9. Code of Conduct in Library Premises

Members are expected to observe the following standards of behavior at all times:

- **Silence and decorum:** Loud conversations, music without headphones, and disruptive behavior are not permitted.
- **Respect for property:** Writing or marking on library books, furniture, or walls is strictly prohibited.
- **No reservation of seats by proxy:** Asking another person to “save” a seat using personal belongings for extended periods is discouraged and subject to the 20-minute rule (Section 7.1).
- **Food and drink:** Restricted to designated café zones only.
- **Smoking and prohibited substances:** Strictly forbidden anywhere in the library building, including restrooms and stairwells.
- **Photography/recording:** Not permitted within library premises without prior written permission from the Chief Librarian, except for personal study notes.
- **Dress code:** Members are expected to adhere to the University’s general dress code policy while in the library, as in all academic buildings.

Violations of the code of conduct will be addressed progressively: verbal warning → written warning recorded in member file → temporary suspension of library privileges (7–30 days) → referral to the University Discipline Committee for repeated or severe violations.

10. Reference Section and Special Collections

10.1 Reference Section

The Reference Section (1st Floor) houses encyclopedias, dictionaries, yearbooks, atlases, and standards/codes used by Engineering and Management departments. These materials are for **in-library use only** and may not be removed from the floor.

10.2 Special Collections and Archives

- The Archives Room (3rd Floor, restricted access) contains rare manuscripts, historical university records, and donor collections.
- Access requires prior written permission from the Chief Librarian, submitted at least **3 working days** in advance, stating the purpose of access.
- White cotton gloves (provided by Archives staff) must be worn when handling fragile materials.
- No photography, photocopying, or scanning of Archive materials is permitted without explicit written authorization, in keeping with copyright and preservation requirements.

10.3 Theses and Dissertations Repository

Completed M.Phil./Ph.D. theses are housed in both physical (Reference Section) and digital (Institutional Repository) form. Current students may consult these for research reference but may not photocopy entire theses; reasonable excerpting for citation purposes is permitted in accordance with the University’s Academic Integrity Policy.

11. Inter-Library Loan (ILL) Services

Greenfield University Library participates in a consortium with partner institutions (Greenfield Network of Academic Libraries – GNAL) to facilitate access to materials not held in our collection.

11.1 Eligibility and Procedure

- Available to faculty, research scholars, and final-year postgraduate students with HOD endorsement.
- Requests are submitted via the ILL Request Form at the Reference Desk or online through the Library Portal.
- Processing time: **5-10 working days**, depending on the partner institution's response time.

11.2 Charges

Service	Charge
ILL request processing	INR 100 per item (non-refundable)
Courier/transport (if applicable)	At actual cost, borne by requester
Photocopy via ILL (where loan not possible)	INR 2 per page

Items obtained via ILL follow the lending institution's loan period and are non-renewable through Greenfield University. Late return results in fines as per Section 6.1, charged at the higher of the two institutions' rates.

12. Photocopying, Printing, and Scanning Services

Service	Location	Rate
Black & White Photocopy	Ground Floor Service Counter	INR 1 per page
Color Photocopy	Ground Floor Service Counter	INR 8 per page
B/W Printing (from library computers)	Digital Resource Center	INR 2 per page
Color Printing	Digital Resource Center	INR 10 per page
Scanning to Email/USB	Digital Resource Center	INR 1 per page
Spiral Binding	Ground Floor Service Counter	INR 30 per document

Copyright Notice: In compliance with applicable copyright law, photocopying is limited to a maximum of **20% of any single book** or one complete chapter, whichever is less, for personal academic use only. Reproduction of entire books or unauthorized commercial use of library materials is strictly prohibited.

13. Library Card and Access Control

- Entry to the Library requires tapping the University ID/Library Card at the turnstile gates. Tailgating (entering without scanning) is a security violation.
- Bags larger than A4 laptop-bag size must be deposited in lockers at the entrance (free of charge; member assumes responsibility for valuables).
- Laptops, tablets, and personal books carried into the library should be declared and shown to security staff at entry/exit to avoid confusion with library-owned materials.
- The Library uses RFID-tagged materials; attempting to remove an item without proper checkout will trigger the security alarm and is treated as a serious disciplinary matter, potentially resulting in suspension of library and University privileges.

14. Disciplinary Action and Appeals

14.1 Categories of Violations

Severity	Examples	Typical Consequence
Minor	Noise, food in reading room, minor lateness in return	Verbal/written warning
Moderate	Repeated overdue items, minor damage to books, misuse of seating	Fine + temporary privilege suspension (up to 30 days)
Major	Theft/attempted theft, deliberate damage, card sharing, harassment of staff	Suspension of all library privileges (1 semester or more) + referral to Discipline

		Committee
Severe	Vandalism, threats to staff, repeated major violations	Referral to University Disciplinary Committee; may affect academic standing

14.2 Appeals Process

A member who disputes a fine, penalty, or disciplinary action may file a written appeal with the Chief Librarian within **10 working days** of the action being recorded. The Chief Librarian will respond within **7 working days**. Unresolved appeals may be escalated to the Library Advisory Committee, which meets monthly and includes faculty, student, and administrative representatives.

15. Frequently Encountered Situations

Q: I am graduating soon. What do I need to do regarding the library? A: You must clear all outstanding fines and return all borrowed items before applying for your “No Dues Certificate.” This is mandatory for degree conferral and transcript release.

Q: Can I bring a guest into the library? A: Guests are permitted only with prior approval from the Chief Librarian and must be accompanied at all times. Daily guest passes can be requested at the Help Desk.

Q: What happens if the library system shows I have a book I already returned? A: Report this immediately at the Circulation Desk with your return date/time if known. Discrepancies are investigated within 3 working days and any wrongly applied fines are reversed.

Q: Can faculty issue books on behalf of students for class projects? A: Yes, under the “Bulk Course Issue” scheme, faculty may issue up to 20 books for a class project for a maximum of 7 days, coordinated through the Departmental Library Liaison.

Q: Is there a grace period before fines start? A: No, fines begin accruing the day after the due date. However, the Library e-portal sends automatic reminder notifications 2 days before the due date as a courtesy.

16. Contact Information

Department	Contact	Email
Chief Librarian's Office	+91-522-LIB-0001	librarian@greenfield.edu
Circulation Desk	+91-522-LIB-0002	circulation@greenfield.edu
Digital Resource Center	+91-522-LIB-0003	digitallib@greenfield.edu
Reference Desk	+91-522-LIB-0004	reference@greenfield.edu
ILL Coordinator	+91-522-LIB-0005	ill@greenfield.edu
Lost & Found / Security	+91-522-LIB-0006	libsecurity@greenfield.edu

Central Library Address: Greenfield University Main Campus, Library Block, Sector 9, Greenfield City - 226001

This document is reviewed annually by the Library Advisory Committee and is subject to amendment. The most current version is always available on the University Portal under Policies → Library Services.

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